

Here is an executive summary based on the review. It is formatted as a formal advisory document, ready to be presented to leadership or a client's steering committee.

Executive Summary: Data Classification & Protection Policy Review

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Project Scope: Cloud Infrastructure Migration Readiness

Date: July 9, 2026

Bottom-Line Conclusion

The current Data Classification and Protection Policy (v1.2) provides a solid foundation for legacy, on-premise environments, but it is **critically deficient** for the upcoming cloud infrastructure migration. If the organization migrates data under the current policy, it will face significant operational risks, potential data exposure, and severe compliance violations. A major policy revision (v2.0) must be finalized and approved before the cloud deployment goes live.

Top Business Risks

- **Unclear Accountability (High Risk):** The current policy assumes all infrastructure is managed internally. It lacks a Shared Responsibility Model, meaning if a cloud breach occurs, it is entirely unclear where the Cloud Service Provider's liability ends and the organization's accountability begins.
- **Cloud Data Exposure (High Risk):** The policy does not account for cloud-native threats. Without mandates for managing API keys or securing external storage (e.g., S3 buckets), sensitive company data is highly vulnerable to accidental public exposure.

Compliance & Regulatory Impact

- **Cross-Border Data Violations:** The existing policy is silent on geographic data residency. Moving "Confidential" or "Restricted" data to cloud servers located outside our primary jurisdiction without Legal/GRC sign-off risks immediate violations of GDPR and other privacy frameworks, carrying heavy financial penalties.
- **Audit Failures:** The policy references outdated security frameworks, failing to align with the recently updated NIST CSF 2.0 and ISO 27001:2022 standards.

Remediation & Resource Ask

To secure the cloud migration and ensure regulatory compliance, leadership approval is requested for the following immediate actions:

1. **Policy Revision (Process):** Authorize the GRC team to draft policy v2.0. This update will integrate the necessary Shared Responsibility definitions and establish strict cross-border data routing rules.

2. **Tooling Investment (Technology):** Approve the procurement of a Cloud Security Posture Management (CSPM) tool. Policy alone cannot stop cloud misconfigurations; automated scanning is required to enforce the new data protection rules.
3. **Target Deadline:** The GRC team will submit the revised policy to the Steering Committee for final sign-off by **August 1, 2026**.